

Speaker 1: [00:00:02] Well, first of all, do you have a preference on how we refer to your partner? Boyfriend, spouse, partner by his name?

Speaker 2: [00:00:13] By his name? [Partner's Name].

Speaker 1: [00:00:14] [Partner's Name], very well. How long have you been with this person? With [Partner's Name].

Speaker 2: [00:00:20] It's been... It's going to be [1-5] years soon, [1-5] years.

Speaker 1: [00:00:26] Well, to start, I would like you to simply talk about the love story you are currently experiencing with [Partner's Name].

Speaker 2: [00:00:34] From the meeting up to now, for example. Okay. Well, I met her at my [location]. Knowing that from a previous relationship, I have a little girl. She didn't have any children. Actually, it happened very quickly between us. We got together in [Month], and by [Month], I had moved in with her, and in [Month], we had a civil union. And then in [Month] of this year, we got married. We have a lot of projects. The daily life of a couple, I think.

Speaker 1: [00:01:18] Can you tell me more about the meeting you mentioned briefly?

Speaker 2: [00:01:25] According to her, she fell in love at first sight. Not me, honestly, I don't know what love at first sight is. I've never experienced it. It started as a game at [location]. We started betting on things. At first, it was a coffee, then a kebab, and so on. I won my coffee, so we went to have a coffee after [location], and that's when everything happened.

Speaker 1: [00:02:02] So if I understand correctly, there was a sort of challenge that you won, and you asked [Partner's Name] for a coffee, right? Very well. Can you tell me a bit more about how the relationship developed? You briefly mentioned the civil union and now being married, but I'd like more details.

Speaker 2: [00:02:29] More details? What interests me here is your feelings about the relationship, your experience. What led you to the civil union, getting married, living together or not, and so on.

Speaker 2: [00:02:53] Okay. When we got together, I was still living with my daughter's father, but we were no longer together. It was complicated, especially for her, knowing I lived with my ex, which is normal. Whenever I had a weekend or after work, I would go see her. I tried to reassure her as much as I could. We had a lot of arguments because of the situation. I let the [Event] pass because of my daughter. In [Month], it's my daughter's birthday and [Event]. I told her we'd move in together after the holidays. That's what we did. Things got better in our relationship. I took a risk by leaving everything to live with her, but I wanted to show her I was sincere in my feelings.

Speaker 2: [00:04:40] [1-5] months later, we had a civil union because we felt the need to make things official to prove to ourselves it was serious. We had plans to get married and buy a house and have a baby. We realized that for her to be recognized as the second parent, we needed to be married. It also simplified administrative matters for buying a house. We decided to get married sooner than planned. We had a small but wonderful wedding.

Speaker 1: [00:05:53] You mentioned that you complete each other. How do you feel your relationship compares to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2: [00:06:29] With [Partner's Name], we complement each other a lot. We have the same tastes in many things but not the same hobbies. She loves [Name]; I don't. But we balance each other. She helps me see things differently when I'm stuck. We also value our freedom. If I want to go out with friends, she doesn't mind as long as I let her know. In my previous relationship, I didn't have this freedom.

Speaker 1: [00:07:36] You weren't as free?

Speaker 2: [00:07:37] Yes, I wasn't as free. Despite the routine, every day is different. There's always something that makes our day unique.

Speaker 1: [00:07:59] I want to be sure I understand about your meeting with [Partner's Name]. She fell in love at first sight, but not you. Who approached the other first?

Speaker 2: [00:08:19] [Partner's Name] did. My colleague, who is a friend, noticed she kept looking at me. I hadn't noticed before. When he pointed it out, I paid more attention. We started a game at [location], which led to our first coffee together, and that's how it all started.

Speaker 1: [00:08:54] You mentioned that she had love at first sight, but you didn't. You fall in love with personality rather than physical appearance because you're pansexual.

Speaker 2: [00:09:40] Yes, for me, love at first sight doesn't exist. I fall in love with who a person is inside.

Speaker 1: [00:10:46] Comparing your current relationship with your previous ones, what qualities do you value in your relationship with [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 2: [00:11:34] The freedom, the uniqueness of each day, the complicity. I've never been as close with someone before. The support. It's tough sometimes, but she's always there for me.

Speaker 1: [00:12:18] You've had [1-5] or [1-5] serious relationships before [Partner's Name]. What qualities do you see in your current relationship that were missing in your previous ones?

Speaker 2: [00:12:40] She considers my emotions. I'm prone to migraines, and she takes care of me. It's important.

Speaker 1: [00:13:26] What would you describe as a high-quality relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:13:47] What I have now, simply. We love each other but aren't too dependent on each other. We support each other, and everything runs smoothly.

Speaker 1: [00:14:19] How do you know you're in a relationship where you give each other freedom?

Speaker 2: [00:14:56] We set clear boundaries from the beginning. It's important to know where the limits are to avoid mistakes.

Speaker 1: [00:15:06] How do you know you're in a trusting relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:15:33] Trust is a feeling. One mistake, and it's gone. I don't forgive easily.

Speaker 1: [00:16:04] When was your relationship most spontaneous?

Speaker 2: [00:16:21] When I moved in with her. I was just supposed to bring a few things but ended up bringing everything and staying. All thanks to Covid.

Speaker 1: [00:16:51] Thanks to Covid.

Speaker 2: [00:16:56] Covid had some good sides.

Speaker 1: [00:17:05] When was your relationship the most trusting?

Speaker 2: [00:17:05] From the beginning. I wanted to give her a chance. One mistake, and trust is gone.

Speaker 1: [00:17:33] Setting clear rules and boundaries is important to you?

Speaker 2: [00:17:53] Yes, it's important to avoid mistakes and know what's acceptable.

Speaker 1: [00:18:34] What would you consider a low-quality relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:18:34] Being too dependent on each other, jealousy, lack of communication. Communication is crucial.

Speaker 1: [00:19:09] How do you know you're too dependent on each other?

Speaker 2: [00:19:17] When you live together, it's normal to be close, but if she tells me when I need to be home, that's too much. We need our own space.

Speaker 1: [00:20:13] When was your relationship too dependent on each other?

Speaker 2: [00:20:19] At the beginning, when I moved in. We were a bit too close, but it passed.

Speaker 1: [00:20:47] When was your relationship the least dependent?

Speaker 2: [00:20:55] I don't really know. It happened naturally.

Speaker 1: [00:21:17] What are other important aspects of a romantic relationship for you?

Speaker 2: [00:21:30] I think I've covered everything.

Speaker 1: [00:21:46] Based on your experience, what is love for you?

Speaker 2: [00:21:52] Love is being with someone who can be a best friend and a partner. Someone you can talk to about anything, do things with, and share common interests. It's having more happy moments than bad ones.

Speaker 1: [00:22:39] How important is love in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2: [00:22:50] It's very important.

Speaker 1: [00:23:02] Can you elaborate?

Speaker 2: [00:23:07] It's important for daily well-being, to feel less alone. It adds excitement to life. So yes, it's important.

Speaker 1: [00:24:00] How do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2: [00:24:31] She tells me and shows it through small gestures, like cooking for me or organizing outings when I'm down. It's the little things.

Speaker 1: [00:25:11] How do you see it?

Speaker 2: [00:25:15] I can sense it through her actions and looks. When she has stars in her eyes, it says everything.

Speaker 1: [00:25:51] Can you describe a recent positive interaction with [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 2: [00:25:59] This morning, before leaving for work, I kissed her goodbye and called her later to make sure she was awake and on time. It's small, but I like it.

Speaker 1: [00:26:37] And a recent negative interaction?

Speaker 2: [00:26:49] [redacted].

Speaker 1: [00:27:40] [redacted].

Speaker 2: [00:27:41] [redacted].

Speaker 1: [00:27:53] What challenges do you face in your relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:28:04] Apart from our projects, the biggest challenges are buying a house and having a baby as a same-sex couple. These are the most concrete and time-consuming

challenges. We're both impatient, which sometimes affects our morale, but we support each other.

Speaker 1: [00:28:58] What challenges have you already overcome?

Speaker 2: [00:29:03] My wife has heart problems, which was difficult at first with frequent hospital visits. Now it's become part of our routine, but at first, it was very stressful for me. I've learned to handle it better now.

Speaker 1: [00:29:59] Sometimes relationships aren't always rosy. Can you talk about the conflicts and arguments you have?

Speaker 2: [00:30:10] She's very jealous. Whenever I talk about male colleagues, she gets upset, thinking they're hitting on me, which isn't true. This causes most of our arguments.

Speaker 1: [00:30:44] What solutions do you find during conflicts?

Speaker 2: [00:31:08] We compromise, make small sacrifices, or acknowledge when one of us is right or wrong.

Speaker 1: [00:31:29] How often do these disputes occur, considering minor daily issues?

Speaker 2: [00:31:34] Major disputes happen maybe once a month. Minor daily issues are just nagging and don't last long.

Speaker 1: [00:32:07] At the beginning of your relationship with [Partner's Name], you mentioned many arguments related to your ex-partner. Can you elaborate?

Speaker 2: [00:32:27] She was afraid I wasn't serious or was playing games, given my living situation with my ex. It was stressful for her.

Speaker 1: [00:32:57] She still has these fears?

Speaker 2: [00:32:58] Yes, but less so now that we live together. But I still need to interact with my ex because of our daughter, which still stresses her out.

Speaker 1: [00:33:21] She feared you weren't taking the relationship seriously?

Speaker 2: [00:33:24] Yes, due to her past bad experiences, she was wary.

Speaker 1: [00:33:45] How did you work on this issue?

Speaker 2: [00:34:18] I tried to reassure her as much as possible with words. Communication was key. I couldn't make promises but assured her it would happen.

Speaker 1: [00:34:46] Besides communication and introspection, how do you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:35:12] By having small gestures towards each other, like cooking her favorite meal when she's tired.

Speaker 1: [00:35:54] What could make you leave your partner?

Speaker 2: [00:36:08] Betrayal. If she has feelings for someone else, it's over for me.

Speaker 1: [00:36:21] That would be a betrayal for you?

Speaker 2: [00:36:24] Yes, because if she has feelings for someone else, it means I no longer fulfill her.

Speaker 1: [00:36:32] Are there other forms of betrayal?

Speaker 2: [00:36:52] Beyond having feelings for someone else, no.

Speaker 1: [00:36:59] So, the only thing that could make you leave is betrayal.

Speaker 2: [00:37:08] The betrayal, or simply if one day she no longer has feelings or I no longer have feelings at all towards her. Then yes, a decision would need to be made.

Speaker 1: [00:37:21] Do you think this relationship is good for you? Yes. Yes. But still?

Speaker 2: [00:37:30] But still? Let's say that when I met [Partner's Name], I had lost a lot of weight, to the point where I was even thin, I was hollow. I really looked anorexic. Sickly, in fact. And since I've been with her, I've gained a little weight. She cooks well. And I also see it through my mom, who always tells me or tells [Partner's Name] that I look happy, radiant, and sparkling since I've been with her. She says she's happy to see me like this. That's how I know this relationship is good for me.

Speaker 1: [00:38:13] It can also be a good relationship if it helps with daily functioning, regulated thanks to the partner, to the relationship. Can you give examples of this for you?

Speaker 2: [00:38:29] Uh. No, I don't have examples. Not much. Uh. No specific examples, nothing comes to mind right now. Yes, on that.

Speaker 1: [00:39:08] Daily functioning regulated by the relationship or the partner helping you, you don't have any examples? No.

Speaker 2: [00:39:18] Not particularly.

Speaker 1: [00:39:21] It could be related to the fact that you told me you had lost a lot of weight. Yes, with [Partner's Name], you regained a weight that seemed more, more adequate. Yes. Could this be linked to daily functioning regulated by the partner? Something that helped you regulate yourself?

Speaker 2: [00:39:43] Maybe. Yes, yes.

Speaker 1: [00:39:45] So, if that's the case, how?

Speaker 2: [00:39:50] How? She makes me meals. Also, the fact that I am happy, simply, affects my health. I didn't think it could happen, but it affects health, mental health.

Speaker 1: [00:40:12] Perhaps there are internal states that she has helped to regulate or soothe, or something like that? Yes, maybe, yes. Uh-huh. It could also be that the partner or the relationship helps to achieve personal goals. Is that something?

Speaker 2: [00:40:38] Well, yes and no. Before I met [Partner's Name], I didn't want to get married. Well, now I'm married. She changed my mind on that. I always wanted to have [1-5] children, so having another child was always a personal goal of mine. Buying a house, too. We're trying to achieve those goals together, so that plays a big role.

Speaker 1: [00:41:22] Do you think you are the same person as before your relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:41:29] Yes, yes, yes, yes, I think I am still the same. Maybe she opened my mind on some points. There are things I see differently now that I might have been closed off to before. But yes, I am still the same.

Speaker 1: [00:41:55] So, the relationship hasn't changed you? No, if I understand what you're saying. Because I was.

Speaker 2: [00:42:03] Also less stressed, less nervous. But that's all.

Speaker 1: [00:42:08] That's all. And regarding your partner, do you think she has changed during and compared to before the relationship?

[00:42:17] Yes, yes, yes, yes.

Speaker 2: [00:42:22] I made her change in many ways. But for the better. I'm listening. Well, let's say I calmed her down because she used to do a lot of foolish things before.

Speaker 1: [00:42:41] She used to do a lot of foolish things. Right.

Speaker 2: [00:42:45] Big foolish things.

Speaker 1: [00:42:46] Big foolish things.

Speaker 2: [00:42:47] So, as they say, I tamed the wild stallion. Right. Uh.

Speaker 1: [00:43:01] What kind of big foolish things? Can you talk more about that?

Speaker 2: [00:43:07] Uh. I won't go into details, but things like having problems with the law, wandering around aimlessly, she couldn't stay in one place. Just the fact that she took an apartment before being with me was already a big step for her. But she always said she

wouldn't stay in the apartment for long because she didn't like staying in the same place too long. Well, it's been [1-5] years now. She had a tendency to move a lot, but now less so.

Speaker 1: [00:43:48] And you say you changed her, in what way?

Speaker 2: [00:43:55] She is less, how to say, less on edge, less angry. Before, if someone looked at her the wrong way, she would immediately react aggressively. I changed her regarding that, and her lifestyle management. Even her mom tells me that she has become a better person.

Speaker 1: [00:44:38] A better person.

[00:44:39] Yes, so there you go.

Speaker 1: [00:44:47] Would you say, for example, that this is a relationship where you feel safe?

Speaker 2: [00:44:54] Safe? In general, yes.

Speaker 1: [00:45:02] Yes. Yes. I saw you hesitate, so.

Speaker 2: [00:45:11] Let's say, maybe [6-10] months ago, I would have said no. But now, yes. Yes, yes.

Speaker 1: [00:45:22] Why [6-10] months ago would you have said no, and now yes?

Speaker 2: [00:45:27] Because she always wanted to achieve our projects together. But there were many things she had to change to achieve those projects. It was a lot to ask of her. At one point, I almost told her to let it go. But she pulled through and did what was needed. [6-10] months ago, I might have said maybe not, but now yes.

Speaker 1: [00:46:16] Would you say you can open up to your partner, to [Partner's Name], about your experiences, thoughts, identity, without fear of judgment or repercussions?

Speaker 2: [00:46:31] Oh yes, no problem. Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:46:33] Can you give examples of that? Moments when you were able to open up?

Speaker 2: [00:46:41] Generally, I confide everything. I say everything I feel. There's never been a problem. Even if it doesn't please her, she might nag a bit or ask for explanations. But no, I've never had a problem, I always say everything.

Speaker 1: [00:47:15] Always open about who you are.

Speaker 2: [00:47:18] Yes, yes, yes.



Speaker 1: [00:47:21] Feeling safe can also mean being able to get comfort or attention from the other in times of danger or distress. Is that something that is.

Speaker 2: [00:47:35] Yes, no problem.

Speaker 1: [00:47:37] Do you have examples of that? Can you think of something?

Speaker 2: [00:47:43] Danger? No, because I never felt in danger. But we had a tough time once because we were set on a house, but didn't get the loan. We were really heartbroken. It affected us both deeply, even the pets seemed sad. One day we decided to focus on our wedding instead of the house. It helped us get over the disappointment. We supported each other through it.

Speaker 1: [00:49:03] Now I'd like to talk about another aspect of relationships: sexuality. It can be more or less important in a relationship. What about for you?

Speaker 2: [00:49:19] Is it important or not for you? Yes, it is. I wouldn't say it's the cornerstone of the relationship, but it's pretty important for the couple. The need to connect.

Speaker 1: [00:49:36] The need to connect? That's it?

Speaker 2: [00:49:38] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:49:40] But still?

Speaker 2: [00:49:44] Sometimes we feel the need to connect, and a simple hug isn't enough. We need to do, to do...

Speaker 1: [00:50:05] To simply do?

Speaker 2: [00:50:08] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:50:11] Currently, approximately, what is the frequency of your sexual relations?

Speaker 2: [00:50:18] Approximately. I would say between... It depends, three to six times a month.

Speaker 1: [00:50:39] Would you say you are satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2: [00:50:43] Yes? No. Sometimes we both want more, but we're so tired from work and our irregular schedules that we simply don't have the energy. It's not that we don't want to, it's just fatigue.

Speaker 1: [00:51:16] Work-related fatigue.

Speaker 2: [00:51:17] Yes, yes, because our schedules are always off.

Speaker 1: [00:51:25] Between the two of you, you mean.

Speaker 2: [00:51:27] No, staggered schedules. For example, this morning I started at [Time] and finished at [Time]. It's exhausting.

Speaker 1: [00:51:39] What would make you more satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2: [00:51:44] More time. Less fatigue too.

Speaker 1: [00:51:53] I'm going to present you a scale. I will share my screen and I would like you to respond to the two items on this scale. Let me share it. Can you see it properly?

Speaker 2: [00:52:08] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:52:10] In general, my partner really listens to me. The scale goes from 1 to 9, with 1 being not at all true and 9 being completely true. Where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2: [00:52:21] I would say seven. Seven. Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:52:24] Why seven?

Speaker 2: [00:52:26] Seven because sometimes, no. Sometimes there are misses. Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:52:34] What do you think of?

Speaker 2: [00:52:37] Often, it's about household chores. When I tell her to do this or that, there are always things that are either not done or forgotten, or she says, but no, I swear you didn't tell me that! But I did!

Speaker 1: [00:53:06] So why not eight? Or why not six for example?

Speaker 2: [00:53:11] Not six because it happens, but not every day or every two days. And yes, I don't know.

Speaker 1: [00:53:28] It's not all the time. Take the time to think about it.

Speaker 2: [00:53:34] Why not eight? Because it would tend to annoy me. So I put seven.

Speaker 1: [00:53:48] My partner is generally attentive to my needs. On the same scale. Where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2: [00:53:56] I would say nine. Nine? Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:54:00] Why nine?

Speaker 2: [00:54:02] Nine because [Partner's Name] listens to my needs much more than I listen to hers, I admit. I tend to overlook some things concerning her, which is my fault because she always takes care of me.

Speaker 1: [00:54:24] So why not eight?

Speaker 2: [00:54:27] Why not eight? Because even for something simple, like we're watching a movie on the couch and I say I don't have a glass to drink from, she will get up without me asking and get my glass even though she was comfortable and I could have gotten it myself. It's really for little things like that. She does it without complaining, without me asking.

Speaker 1: [00:54:58] How satisfied are you with your relationship? It ranges from completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, uncertain, neutral, somewhat satisfied, very satisfied, to completely satisfied.

Speaker 2: [00:55:11] I am very satisfied.

Speaker 1: [00:55:14] Very satisfied. Yes. So, if we transposed that into a numerical scale, with zero being not at all satisfied and ten being completely satisfied, where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2: [00:55:31] Between eight and nine.

Speaker 1: [00:55:33] Between eight and nine? Yes. More like eight or more like nine?

Speaker 2: [00:55:42] I'll put nine.

Speaker 1: [00:55:44] Why do you put nine?

Speaker 2: [00:55:47] I put nine because [redacted].

Speaker 1: [00:56:10] So why not eight then? Oh, pardon, I'm listening.

Speaker 2: [00:56:14] Pardon. Especially since there is no reason to be jealous. So, there you go.

Speaker 1: [00:56:20] No reason to be jealous.

Speaker 2: [00:56:22] Yes, because there is absolutely nothing. There's nothing. So why not eight? Because everything else is fine.

Speaker 1: [00:56:38] Very well. We're approaching the end of the interview. Is there anything you would like to add about the things you've talked to me about?

Speaker 2: [00:56:54] No, no.

Speaker 1: [00:56:56] No. You talked about how you met [Partner's Name], how it happened, what's important for you in a relationship like freedom, respect, spontaneity, communication. What constitutes a low-quality relationship for you, like lack of communication, jealousy. We also talked about love and its importance in the relationship. You mentioned conflicts you have with [Partner's Name], often related to male colleagues or your ex-partner, linked to her

jealousy. You believe the relationship is good for you since you've gained weight and your mother sees you as happier. You said the relationship hasn't changed you but it has changed your partner. You mentioned taming the wild stallion, or something about taming the wild stallion.

Speaker 2: [00:58:17] The wild stallion? Yes, that's it. Now she's a domesticated pony.

Speaker 1: [00:58:23] A domesticated pony now. Also, you feel safe in the relationship. Maybe not six months ago, but now yes, since she has made efforts to make certain things better. You also mentioned that sexuality is important for you, maybe not the cornerstone, but close, and that with your current schedules, you need more time to fully enjoy your sexuality together. Is there anything else you would like to clarify, develop, or correct about what we discussed?

Speaker 2: [00:59:10] No, everything is fine.

Speaker 1: [00:59:12] You feel we covered everything important about your relationship with [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 2: [00:59:16] It summarizes my relationship with [Partner's Name] well.

Speaker 1: [00:59:19] Very well, I will stop the recording. Yes.